
Questions on an idea regarding misleading material conditional

2 Nachrichten

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Mo. 17. Sept. 2018, 16:11

An: <g.priest@unimelb.edu.au>

Dear Professor Priest,

I am a postdoc of theoretical physics with some background in mathematics. The (ab)use of language together with formal logics has always bugged me, so I drafted an explanation for myself and possibly others, how to deal with logical consequences alias implications.

The short version is that the material consequence $a \rightarrow b$ should be either spoken as "If a, then b, or a is false", or an ambiguous case of "irrelevance" should be introduced to represent "If a, then b" exactly via a different operation corresponding to a logical consequence. From a short literature search I found out that the latter change is related to paraconsistent logics (e.g. LP) and relevance logics, but I have not yet found an exact match of this interpretation.

Now I am really no expert in the field and know that you are kind of a "guru" in logics, so I wanted to ask you if you could take a quick look if what I wrote makes sense, recommend some literature on this specific topic, and answer a few questions. I hope this will take you only a very brief amount of time but it could help me save a lot. So for now the most- important questions:

1) Is the approach I am describing just the same as relevance logics or logics of paradox, or might there be more to it? Is there any equivalent in intuitionist logic or some other non-classical logic?

2) For a statement a I would like to distinguish

- * a
- * a is true
- * a is false

Are the latter two also considered as statements, or is there a better name for them?

3) Do you see any embarrassing misuse of words, letters, brackets etc. that hurt the eye of an expert immediately?

I would be very grateful if you could help me out on this, or indicate where to find further information.

All the best,
Christopher Albert
paper_logic.pdf

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Di. 18. Sept. 2018, 13:06

An: <g.priest@unimelb.edu.au>

PS: Here is an updated version, I had mixed up some cases in the end.

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